Activity 10: Wellbeing Programme Management Review

Learning outcome: LO3 Objective: Assess programme effectiveness and recommend scale, adaptation or stop Expected output: Balanced programme dashboard and management decision paper Primary source: https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/mckinsey-guide-to-navigating-the-new-world-of-work/thriving-at-work-building-resilience-wellness-and-motivation

Goal

Turn reach, experience, work-condition, outcome and cost evidence into a decision-ready management review.

Real-world scenario

McKinsey's workplace research presents wellbeing as a leadership priority and highlights organisational enablers such as psychological safety, purpose and adaptable support. The source supports a systems perspective; the fictional programme dataset must be evaluated on its own quality and cannot inherit causal conclusions.

ApexFin Services, a fictional 760-person employer, piloted manager training, protected focus time, EAP navigation and peer mentoring for 12 months. Participation rose, but absence and turnover moved differently across units. Leaders ask whether to scale nationally.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- All programme, outcome, cost, baseline and comparison data are fictional.
- Business units were not randomly assigned; workload and leadership changes occurred during the pilot.
- Small groups and sensitive service data must be aggregated before management reporting.
- The decision options are scale, adapt and extend pilot, pause, or stop-not simply pass/fail.

Questions

1. Did delivery reach the intended groups safely and equitably?
2. What evidence supports changes in experience, work conditions and outcomes?
3. Which alternative explanations and data-quality weaknesses limit confidence?
4. What should management scale, adapt, pause or stop, and what is the next review trigger?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Reconstruct the logic model

Map inputs, activities, reach, experience, capability or condition change and outcomes. Mark where the causal chain is unsupported.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Validate the dataset

Check definitions, periods, denominators, missingness, duplicates, group size, baseline comparability and privacy suppression.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Assess implementation

Compare planned with delivered dose, manager participation, service quality, access and safeguards. Explain material deviations.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Analyse reach and equity

Calculate eligibility, awareness, uptake, repeat use and completion by safe segment. Identify who was missed or burdened.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Evaluate outcomes cautiously

Compare baseline and trend for experience, work conditions, wellbeing and operational measures. State confounders and avoid unsupported causation.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Assess value and risk

Compare cost with reach, quality and credible outcome signals. Review incidents, complaints, vendor risk and unintended effects.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 7: Make component decisions

For each intervention, recommend scale, adapt, pause or stop with evidence confidence, condition and owner.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 8: Run management review

Present decision, evidence, equity, uncertainty, resource need, action, communication and next review trigger; record management acceptance.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Balanced programme dashboard and management decision paper

Acceptance criteria

The review validates data, follows the logic model, separates implementation from outcome, analyses equity, names confounders, avoids causal overclaiming and gives component-level decisions with owners and review triggers.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which assumption changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before relying on the result?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next decision or mitigation?

4. Which review trigger or future exercise should follow?

Source note

Source accessed 16 August 2026: https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/mckinsey-guide-to-navigating-the-new-world-of-work/thriving-at-work-building-resilience-wellness-and-motivation